



Brand Guidelines

How the CORE identity is put together — the mark, the colours, the type — and what to do with them on a slide, a banner or a printed page.



Four versions. Pick by who is speaking.

The avocado is the constant. What changes is the line underneath it, which names the site the material comes from. Use the plain version when the material represents the network as a whole.



CORE Network

The whole network. Use when no single site is speaking.



TU Clausthal

Material from Clausthal University of Technology, Goslar.



UBB Cluj

Material from Babeş-Bolyai University, Cluj-Napoca.



Uni Rostock

Material from the University of Rostock.

Never rebuild the mark. Do not retype the word CORE, redraw the avocado, change its colours, stretch it, add a shadow or place it in a coloured box. Every version you need already exists as a file — ask for it rather than recreating it.

Four files, so the mark never needs recolouring

Each lockup comes in four variants, one per background type. The avocado is identical in all of them — only the lettering changes, so it stays readable. If the mark looks wrong on your background, you have the wrong file, not a colour problem.



On white

Pure white pages and slides.



On light

Light tints, pale photographs.



On dark

Dark slides, deep photography.



On black

True black only.



The avocado alone

Only where the word CORE already appears nearby — a social avatar, a favicon, a repeated corner mark. It is not a substitute for the full mark on a first impression.

Give it one avocado of room

Keep clear space around the mark equal to **half its height** on every side — which is roughly the height of the avocado itself. Nothing enters that area: no photo edge, no partner logo, no caption, no page border.



The dashed edge shows the minimum clear space.

Smallest usable size

Below these sizes the site name under the mark closes up and stops being readable.

Printed	12 mm tall (about 44 mm wide)
Screen or slide	64 pixels tall (about 233 pixels wide)
Avocado alone	8 mm, or 32 pixels

If you need it smaller than that, use the version without a site name underneath, or the avocado on its own.

Always scale proportionally. Hold Shift while dragging a corner. A mark stretched even slightly reads as a mistake to anyone who knows the brand.

One green does the talking

CORE Green is the brand. The other colours support it — they are not alternatives to it.



CORE Green

#01BC2B

The brand colour. Marks, fills, rules, highlights.



Deep Green

#09781B

Green type, links and buttons. Use this whenever green carries words.



Lime

#C8F200

Inside the avocado, and as a small highlight on dark backgrounds.



Stone Brown

#4C3006

The avocado stone. Rare elsewhere.



Slate

#0F172A

Body text, headlines, dark backgrounds.



Cool Grey

#64748B

Captions, secondary text, fine rules.

Never set text in CORE Green. It is a bright colour and words in it are hard to read on white, especially projected. Use Deep Green whenever green has to carry words. CORE Green is for shapes, not sentences.

Printers: please match to the values above, do not convert blindly. These are screen colours, and CORE Green sits near the edge of what four-colour process can reproduce — a straight conversion comes back noticeably duller. If you are running spot colour, propose a match against #01BC2B and let us confirm it. Large flat areas of the green are the risky case; rules and small marks convert comfortably.

Green is CORE. A second colour can be the host.

Each lab sits inside a university, and material from a specific site may carry that university's own colour alongside the green. This is optional — a site that prefers to stay green simply does, and material for the network as a whole always does.

The rule is about *what each colour means*, not how much of it there is:

CORE Green

The mark, the structure, anything a reader should act on. Present on everything, everywhere.

Host colour

Says where you are. Section labels, rules, institutional marks. Never on a button or a link.

Currently defined



Babes-Bolyai Blue

#034E84

CORE Labs Cluj only. Taken from the university seal.

Goslar and Rostock have not defined one. Their material runs green.

Where the two meet

On the CORE Labs Cluj wordmark the place name runs from the university's blue into CORE's green — the two institutions in one word. This is the only place a brand colour is ever used as a gradient.

CORE Labs
Cluj

Everywhere else, brand colour is flat. No gradient fills, no gradient backgrounds, no gradient headings.

Two typefaces, both free

Poppins for headings, Inter for everything else. Both are open-licensed and free to download and embed, so there is no reason to substitute them.

Poppins

Headings and titles · Semibold 600 to Extrabold 800

Geometric and confident. Short lines only — it is not a typeface for paragraphs.

Inter

Body, captions, labels · Light 300 to Bold 700

Built for screens and small sizes. This paragraph is Inter.

The most common way a CORE document goes wrong. You send a PowerPoint file, the other computer does not have Poppins, it silently swaps in Calibri, and every heading reflows. You will never see it — they will. Embed the fonts in the file, or send a PDF. For anything you are not presenting yourself, send a PDF.

For print: convert type to outlines before sending artwork, or supply the font files with it.

Built for the back row

Use 16:9 widescreen, PowerPoint's default. The person furthest from the screen is about eight metres away, and that — not your laptop — decides every size below.

Margin	Keep a clear margin of about 6% on all four sides. Projectors crop the edges and video calls crop them further.
Title	Poppins Semibold, 32–40 pt. One line. A title that wraps to three lines is a paragraph.
Body	Inter Regular, 24 pt as a floor, never below 18 pt.
Logo	Bottom right, inside the margin, at least 64 pixels tall. Once per slide — and not on the title slide if the mark is already the title slide.
Density	One idea per slide.

Colour in a lit room

A projector washes out contrast — ambient light lifts the blacks and everything drifts toward grey. Colours that look fine on a laptop can disappear on the wall.

- Body text is Slate on white, or white on Slate. Avoid pure black on pure white — it glares.
- Never set text in CORE Green. This matters more projected than it does on screen.
- When choosing between two shades, take the darker one.

Only the middle metre gets read

A standard roll-up is 850 × 2000 mm. Two parts of it are not usable and one part does almost all the work — design around that before anything else.



The three rules

- **The bottom 200 mm does not exist.** The cassette the banner rolls into covers it. A logo or web address placed there will not be visible.
- **The top curls backwards** as the banner leans on its stand. Nothing important in the first 100 mm.
- **Between 1.0 m and 1.55 m is standing eye level.** It is the only band read without effort. Put the one sentence that matters there — not at the top.

Sizes

Headline	40 mm capital height or more
Body	15 mm capitals — roughly 42 pt. Never below 24 pt.
Side margins	60 mm; the print wraps at the edges
Resolution	300 dpi at full size, or vector artwork

A rough guide for any printed piece: **capital letters need to be at least the viewing distance divided by 200.** Read from two metres, that is 10 mm. From five metres, 25 mm. Confirm the exact panel size and bleed with your print supplier before you start — hardware varies.

The short version

● Do

- Use the supplied logo files, unchanged
- Pick the background variant that matches what is behind it
- Leave half the mark's height clear on every side
- Use Deep Green whenever green carries words
- Embed fonts, or send a PDF
- Set type for the person furthest away
- Keep brand colour flat

● Don't

- Redraw, retype or recolour the mark
- Stretch it, rotate it, or add effects to it
- Put text in bright CORE Green
- Crowd the mark with other logos
- Place anything important in the bottom of a roll-up
- Use a gradient as a brand fill
- Substitute a different typeface

Getting the files

Logos are available as vector files, which stay sharp at any size — always ask for vector for print rather than scaling up an image from a website. If you are unsure which version to use, or you want to do something these pages do not cover, ask before you produce it. It is far cheaper than a reprint.

